Questions for search consultant 2026-04-13

Questions for Kettering Blaise Partners, before a first interview

M. Strand, 13 April 2026

Page 1. The work.

1. What proportion of the week is allocation and criteria, and what proportion is capital project delivery?

2. Who writes the space allocation criteria today, and are they published before a decision or after it?

3. Is there a comment window, and are comments logged with the names on them?

4. Who owns the space inventory database, this office or institutional research?

5. Which office runs the classroom utilization study, and does the registrar co-sign it?

6. How many appeals were filed against space decisions in the last three years, and what were they about?

7. What is current ASF per FTE against the state standard?

Page 2. The structure.

8. Who sets the capital priorities, the provost or the vice president?

9. If those two disagree, who decides, and is that decision written down anywhere?

10. How many staff, and how many of those posts are vacant today?

11. What was the operating allocation for this office in each of the last three years?

12. When does the next legislative session convene, and what is the biennial submission date?

13. Deferred maintenance, in dollars and as a percentage of replacement value.

14. How many off-campus leases, at what square footage and what annual cost?

Page 3. The terms.

15. The band, and where in the band the committee expects to land.

16. Retirement: is there reciprocity with a Montana public plan, or does service credit start again at zero?

17. What have the last three people in this post gone on to do?

18. Is the start date negotiable to January, and what breaks if it is?

19. Relocation: the amount, and who chooses the carrier.

20. Does the university expect a candidate to keep this conversation from a current employer? I do not intend to.

21. Is there anything about this post that the committee has not put in the profile?